

# Samuele Bortolotti

PH.D. CANDIDATE IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

✉ samuele.bortolotti@unitn.it | 🏠 samuelebortolotti.github.io | 📧 samuelebortolotti | 🌐 samuele-bortolotti | 🐦 @samubortolotti | 📄 Samuele Bortolotti

## Education

### University of Trento

PH.D. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

Trento, IT

Nov. 2023 - Current

- **Supervisors:** Stefano Teso and Andrea Passerini
- **PhD Scholarship:** Trustworthy Neuro-Symbolic Machine Learning

### University of Trento

MASTER'S DEGREE IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

Trento, IT

Sept. 2021 - Oct. 2023

- **GPA:** 4.0/4.0
- **Grade:** 110/110 cum laude
- **Final dissertation:** "From Models to Arguments and Back", supervised by professors Andrea Passerini and Stefano Teso

### University of Trento

BACHELOR'S DEGREE IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

Trento, IT

Sept. 2018 - Jul. 2021

- **GPA:** 4.0/4.0
- **Grade:** 110/110 cum laude
- **Final dissertation:** "Analysis of user warnings in Wikipedia", supervised by professor Alberto Montresor

## Work Experience

### Structured Machine Learning Group

RESEARCH INTERN

Trento, IT

Nov. 2022 - Jun. 2023

- Work on a novel interactive multi-shot debugging protocol that allows the exchange of arguments between a machine and a user in order to correct the model's beliefs.
- Integrate state-of-the-art eXplainable Artificial Intelligence techniques, such as the 'Right for the Right Reasons' loss, into structured prediction output Neuro-Symbolic models like Coherent Hierarchical Multi-label Classification Networks and Semantic Probabilistic Layers.
- Successfully recover the performance of confounded models in the field of hierarchical classification.

### Eurecat - Centre Tecnològic de Catalunya

JUNIOR DATA SCIENTIST

Barcelona, ES

May. 2021 - Jun. 2021

- Extract Wikipedia data from the Wikipedia dumps - 937GB bz2 and 157GB 7z compressed.
- Design an effective way to extract and analyze the languages spoken by the Wikipedia users - 109'452 database entries.
- Develop a strategy to retrieve Wikipedia users' User Warnings and Wikibreaks, studying how they affect the users' activity level - respectively 25'843 and 2'777'181 database entries.
- Build an automated pipeline to download the dumps, extract the data, and compute the statistics using Docker.

### Alyso Srl

JUNIOR SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

Trento, IT

Jul. 2017 - Aug. 2017

- Create corporate libraries with the aim of handling database connections regardless of the database management system (SQLite, PostgreSQL, MySQL, and Oracle) in Java.
- Develop a Java-based internal software function that can calculate the distance between two buildings using GIS data.
- Develop a web application in HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript to show the obtained results.

### Social IT

JUNIOR SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

Trento, IT

Jun. 2016 - Jul. 2016

- Contribute to the development of an internal Customer Relationship Management System using Java, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, and MySQL.

## Teaching Experience

### Master in Mechatronics Engineering, University of Trento

MACHINE LEARNING FUTURA TUTOR

Trento, IT

Sep. 2024 - Dec. 2024

- Introduction to machine learning, probability theory and linear algebra. Standard machine learning algorithms such as decision trees, k-nearest neighbors, Bayesian networks, support vector machines, and kernel machines, along with an introduction to neural networks and deep learning. Model evaluation, parameter estimation, and common techniques in unsupervised and reinforcement learning.

## Bachelor in Computer Science, University of Trento

Trento, IT

INTRODUCTION TO WEB PROGRAMMING TEACHING ASSISTANT

Feb. - Jun. 2025; Feb. - Jun. 2026

- Fundamentals of web development, including HTTP protocol, HTML, JavaScript, CSS, request-response cycle, asynchronous JavaScript frameworks (AJAX, AJAX), state persistence, and database interaction, with practical experience in common web technologies, DOM manipulation, and the design and development of simple web applications using Java Spring.

## Master in Artificial Intelligence Systems, University of Trento

Trento, IT

MACHINE LEARNING TEACHING ASSISTANT

Sep. 2025 - Dec. 2025

- Introduction to machine learning, probability theory and linear algebra. Standard machine learning algorithms such as decision trees, k-nearest neighbors, Bayesian networks, support vector machines, and kernel machines, along with an introduction to neural networks and deep learning. Model evaluation, parameter estimation, and common techniques in unsupervised and reinforcement learning.

## Publications

### JOURNAL ARTICLES [1]

Symbol Grounding in Neuro-Symbolic AI: A Gentle Introduction to Reasoning Shortcuts

EMANUELE MARCONATO, SAMUELE BORTOLOTTI, EMILE KRIEKEN, PAOLO MORETTIN, ELENA UMILI, ANTONIO VERGARI, EFTHYMIA TSAMOURA, ANDREA PASSERINI, STEFANO TESO

*J. Artif. Intell. Res.* 86 (2026). 2026

### CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS [5]

#### Concise and Logically Consistent Conformal Sets for Neuro-Symbolic Concept-Based Models

SAMUELE BORTOLOTTI, EMANUELE MARCONATO, ANDREA PUGNANA, ANDREA PASSERINI, STEFANO TESO

*The Fortieth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems, 2026*

#### Shortcuts and Identifiability in Concept-based Models from a Neuro-Symbolic Lens

SAMUELE BORTOLOTTI, EMANUELE MARCONATO, PAOLO MORETTIN, ANDREA PASSERINI, STEFANO TESO

*The Thirty-ninth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems, 2025*

#### A Neuro-Symbolic Benchmark Suite for Concept Quality and Reasoning Shortcuts

SAMUELE BORTOLOTTI, EMANUELE MARCONATO, TOMMASO CARRARO, PAOLO MORETTIN, EMILE KRIEKEN, ANTONIO VERGARI, STEFANO TESO, ANDREA PASSERINI

*Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems, 2024*

#### Benchmarking in Neuro-Symbolic AI

ROBIN MANHAEVE, FRANCESCO GIANNINI, MEHDI ALI, DAMIANO AZZOLINI, ALICE BIZZARRI, ANDREA BORGHESI, SAMUELE BORTOLOTTI, LUC DE RAEDT, DEVENDRA SINGH DHAMI, MICHELANGELO DILIGENTI, SEBASTIJAN DUMANCIC, BOI FALTINGS, ELISABETTA GENTILI, ALFONSO GEREVINI, MARCO GORI, TIAS GUNS, MARTIN HOMOLA, KRISTIAN KERSTING, JENS LEHMANN, MICHELE LOMBARDI, LUCA SALVATORE LORELLO, EMANUELE MARCONATO, STEFANO MELACCI, ANDREA PASSERINI, DEBJIT PAUL, FABRIZIO RIGUZZI, STEFANO TESO, NEIL YORKE-SMITH, MARCO LIPPI

*Learning and Reasoning - 4th International Joint Conference on Learning and Reasoning, IJCLR 2024, Nanjing, China, September 20-22, 2024, Proceedings, 2024*

#### BEARS Make Neuro-Symbolic Models Aware of their Reasoning Shortcuts

EMANUELE MARCONATO, SAMUELE BORTOLOTTI, EMILE KRIEKEN, ANTONIO VERGARI, ANDREA PASSERINI, STEFANO TESO

*Proceedings of the Fortieth Conference on Uncertainty in Artificial Intelligence, 2024*

\* = Equal contribution.

## Talks

### Benchmarking in Neuro-Symbolic AI

TAILOR, Online

INVITED TALK

Mar. 2025

### Reasoning Shortcuts in Neuro-Symbolic AI

IML, University of Edinburgh

WORKSHOP TALK

Mar. 2026

### How to Learn and Not Learn Concepts, Symbols, and Representations

University of Edinburgh

INVITED TALK

May. 2026

With Emanuele Marconato

# Main Research Collaborations

## Neuro-Symbolic AI

STEFANO TESO, CiMEC, UNIVERSITY OF TRENTO, ITALY  
ANDREA PASSERINI, DISI, UNIVERSITY OF TRENTO, ITALY  
ANTONIO VERGARI, UNIVERSITY OF EDINBURGH, UK  
EMILE VAN KRIEKEN, VRIJE UNIVERSITEIT AMSTERDAM, THE NETHERLANDS  
HAN ZHAO, UNIVERSITY OF ILLINOIS URBANA-CHAMPAIGN, USA  
EFTHYMIA TSAMOURA, HUAWEI LABS, UK  
TOMMASO CARRARO, DISNEY RESEARCH, SWITZERLAND

## Identifiability and Causality

EMANUELE MARCONATO, CoCaLa, UNIVERSITY OF COPENHAGEN

## Uncertainty Quantification

ANDREA PUGNANA, DISI, UNIVERSITY OF TRENTO

# Reviewing activity

## Conferences

REVIEWER

- Uncertainty in Artificial Intelligence (UAI) 2025, 2026
- Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2025, 2026
- Unifying Concept Representation Learning Workshop at ICLR 2026
- Neurosymbolic AI (NeSy) 2026
- Hybrid Human-Machine Learning and Decision Making at ECML-PKDD 2026
- Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR) 2026

# Extracurricular Training

## Nordic Probabilistic AI School

Copenhagen, DK

ATTENDEE

Jun. 2024

- **Acceptance rate:** 18%.
- **Topics:** Probabilistic models, bayesian workflow, variational inference and optimization, deep generative models, diffusion models, Monte Carlo methods, probabilistic circuits, gaussian processes and causal inference.

## School of Informatics, University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, UK

VISITING RESEARCHER

Mar. 2026 - Jun. 2026

- Visiting the APRIL Lab under the supervision of professor Antonio Vergari.
- Research project on Constraint Learning using Large Language Models.

# Skills

|                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Programming</b>   | Python (proficient), Java (proficient), Ruby (intermediate), JavaScript (intermediate), TypeScript (intermediate), R (intermediate), C++ (intermediate), C (intermediate), C# (academic), Matlab (academic) |
| <b>Miscellaneous</b> | Linux, Git, GitHub, LaTeX, SQL, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Keras                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Languages</b>     | English (C1), Italian (native), German (A2)                                                                                                                                                                 |

# Honors & Awards

|      |                                                                                                       |                |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 2021 | <b>Mobility Grant</b> , Erasmus+ Traineeship Programme (2 months)                                     | Barcelona, ES  |
| 2022 | <b>Merit Grant</b> , Premio allo studio Marco Modena (Cassa Rurale Alto Garda - Rovereto, Trento, IT) | Trento, IT     |
| 2023 | <b>Ph.D. scholarship</b> , Three year sponsorship: rank 6th out of 120 participants                   | Trento, IT     |
| 2025 | <b>Travel Grant</b> , NeurIPS Conference Financial Assistance Award                                   | San Diego, USA |
| 2026 | <b>Mobility Grant</b> , Erasmus+ Traineeship Programme (3 months)                                     | Edinburgh, UK  |